

NATIONAL AERONAUTICS AND SPACE ADMINISTRATION
NASA IT Procurement Office (ITPO)
JUSTIFICATION FOR OTHER THAN FULL AND OPEN COMPETITION
(JOFOC)
For RSMeans FedRAMP Concurrent Complete Plus FY26 (Base Plus 2 One-Year
Options)

1. **Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 6.104-1(a)(1) – Identification of the agency and the contracting activity, and specific identification of the document as a “Justification for other than full and open competition.”**

This document is a justification for other than full and open competition prepared by National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) IT Procurement Office (ITPO).

The procuring agency is the National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA), and the contracting activity is IT Procurement Office (ITPO).

2. **FAR 6.104-1(a)(2) – The nature and/or description of the action being approved:**

This justification provides the rationale for contracting by other than full and open competition to award a sole-source contract to Gordian for RSMeans FedRAMP Concurrent Complete Plus.

3. **FAR 6.104-1(a)(3) – A description of the supplies or services required, to meet the Agency’s needs (including the estimated value):**

NASA Marshall Space Flight Center (MSFC) intends to procure access to RSMeans Data Online – FedRAMP, Concurrent, Complete Plus, for use agency-wide under the Facilities & Real Estate Division (FRED) umbrella. This procurement is for continued access to RSMeans’ comprehensive construction cost database and estimating platform, delivered in a FedRAMP-authorized cloud environment suitable for Federal use. The total estimated value of the proposed order for this renewal is [REDACTED] and the period of performance is as follows:

Description	Period of Performance
Base Year	April 17, 2026 – April 16, 2027
Option Year 1	April 17, 2027 – April 16 2028
Option Year 2	April 17, 2028 – April 16, 2029

The Government requires an industry-recognized construction cost estimating database and web-based platform that delivers continuously updated, location-adjusted construction cost data to ensure accuracy across diverse geographic regions. The system must provide detailed line-item cost information for labor, materials, and equipment, as well as access to historical cost data and trend analysis to support informed forecasting and budgeting decisions. It must

include integration capabilities that enable the efficient development of Independent Government Estimates (IGEs) and comply with federal security requirements, including FedRAMP authorization. Additionally, the platform must offer concurrent licensing to support use across all NASA Centers under FRED. The system shall support comprehensive cost estimating for Construction of Facilities (CoF) projects, including construction, repair, renewal, demolition, and infrastructure modernization efforts agency-wide.

4. FAR 6.104-1(a)(4) – An identification of the statutory authority permitting other than full and open competition:

The statutory authority permitting other than full and open competition is 10 U.S.C. 3204(a)1, as implemented by FAR 6.103-1, Only one responsible source and no other supplies or services will satisfy agency requirements.

5. FAR 6.104-1(a)(5) – A demonstration that the proposed contractor’s unique qualifications or the nature of the acquisition requires use of the authority cited:

The rationale supporting the use of 10 U.S.C. 3204(a)(1) is that Gordian is the sole source provider for this requirement as described below.

RSMeans Data Online – FedRAMP, Concurrent, Complete Plus, developed and distributed exclusively by Gordian, is the only product capable of meeting NASA Marshall Space Flight Center’s requirement for a comprehensive construction cost estimating database and platform. The system contains the proprietary RSMeans Data Online cost database, which is widely accepted across the U.S. construction industry as the benchmark standard for construction cost estimating.

For NASA’s Facilities and Real Estate Division (FRED) and the Construction of Facilities (CoF) program, RSMeans Data Online provides the ability to generate standardized, market-informed Independent Government Estimates (IGEs) that are consistent across the Agency and defensible during acquisition and contract negotiations. The FedRAMP-authorized version of the platform also ensures compliance with federal cybersecurity and cloud security requirements necessary for government IT environments. No other commercially available software product offers the same or similar combination of a nationally recognized construction cost database, proprietary cost modeling methodologies, integration of cost data and estimating tools in a single platform, and FedRAMP-authorized cloud delivery. The RSMeans dataset is proprietary and exclusively owned by Gordian, making it unavailable in any other software or platform. As a result, no other vendor can offer the same product or an equivalent dataset integrated into a comparable estimating platform. While other construction cost estimating tools exist on the market, none combine all of the specific attributes listed above—especially the proprietary RSMeans dataset and the FedRAMP authorization essential for federal government IT environments.

If another product were selected, NASA would lose access to the industry-standard RSMeans cost database used to produce reliable and defensible construction cost estimates. Alternative tools would require the agency to rely on fragmented data sources, outdated references, or manually compiled cost information that will not reflect current market conditions or regional cost variations. This would introduce significant variability and uncertainty into Independent Government Estimates. Without the nationally recognized RSMeans benchmark, estimates would be more difficult to defend during contract negotiations and procurement reviews. Selecting a different product or attempting to replicate RSMeans functionality through manual processes would have measurable impacts on both time and cost. Time impacts would include increased time required to develop Independent Government Estimates due to manual research and compilation of cost data, additional effort required for validation of cost assumptions and regional adjustments and increased review cycles and potential delays during procurement due to less defensible cost estimates. Cost impacts would include higher administrative labor costs associated with manual estimating processes, increased likelihood of inaccurate or incomplete estimates leading to cost growth during project execution and potential need for reprogramming or funding adjustments for Construction of Facilities projects due to inaccurate initial estimates. These impacts will ultimately delay the planning and execution of construction projects supporting mission infrastructure at NASA centers. Because many CoF projects support mission-critical systems, delays or inaccuracies in cost estimating will affect project schedules and infrastructure modernization efforts.

RSMeans Data Online is fully compatible with NASA's existing construction cost estimating processes and methodologies used across the Construction of Facilities program. The platform is already widely used throughout the federal government and within NASA's facilities engineering community of practice. Its estimating structure, cost assemblies, and location factors align with the methodologies used to develop Independent Government Estimates and perform cost analyses for facility planning and construction projects. The continued use of RSMeans ensures consistency and standardization across all NASA Centers when developing cost estimates for construction projects. Because the RSMeans database and platform are proprietary to Gordian and cannot be replicated or distributed by other vendors, no other product is compatible with the existing cost estimating methodologies currently used by NASA facilities organizations.

RSMeans Data Online – FedRAMP, Concurrent, Complete Plus is the only product capable of meeting NASA Marshall Space Flight Center's requirement for a secure, comprehensive, and nationally recognized construction cost estimating platform. The proprietary RSMeans cost database, developed and maintained exclusively by Gordian, cannot be obtained through any other vendor and cannot be replicated by alternative solutions. Gordian has confirmed that they do not offer their RSMeans software through resellers. Procuring this product ensures accurate, defensible, and standardized cost estimates in support of NASA's Construction of Facilities program and mission-critical infrastructure investments.

6. FAR 6.104-1(a)(6) – A description of the efforts made to ensure that offers are solicited from as many potential sources as practicable, including whether a notice was or will be publicized as required by part 5 and, if not, which exception under part 5 applies:

A notice to the Government Point of Entry (GPE) website (Sam.gov) was published on TBD, in accordance with FAR part 5. This posting informed potential sources of NASA's intent to award this sole-source contract to Gordian. The results of this synopsis are summarized in Section 10 below.

7. FAR 6.104-1(a)(7) – A determination by the contracting officer that the anticipated cost to the Government will be fair and reasonable:

The Contracting Officer's signature on this document indicates that the Contracting Officer has determined that the anticipated cost to the government will be fair and reasonable. The Contractor must be required to submit a proposal to be evaluated and negotiated by the Government. Prior to execution of the contractual instrument, a proposal analysis will be performed. The proposal analysis will ensure that the final agreed-to price for the contract action is fair and reasonable. In accordance with FAR 15.4, the Contracting Officer expects to use historical prices for the price analysis.

8. FAR 6.104-1(a)(8) – Description of the market research conducted, and the results, or a statement of the reason market research was not conducted (e.g., urgent, and compelling requirement):

Market research was conducted by reviewing recent market research results for similar or identical supplies/services, through fact finding sessions with other knowledgeable people in Government, and through query of Government databases for relevant information. This market research confirms that Gordian Group is the exclusive provider of RSMeans Data Online FedRAMP Concurrent Complete Plus, as demonstrated by their sole source qualification letter. Additional market research was conducted to identify alternative sources capable of meeting the Government's requirement for reliable, standardized construction cost data to support estimating, budgeting, and independent government cost estimates. Multiple commercial tools were reviewed, and while other tools provide estimating workflows, they primarily rely on user generated or integrated cost data and do not offer a comprehensive, validated cost database as a core function, which is essential for NASA. Additional products that include cost data were also considered; however, these are limited in scope, or trade specific.

No direct substitute was identified that provides the same breadth of data, level of standardization, and industry acceptance as RSMeans. Transitioning to an alternative solution would require reliance on less authoritative or user generated pricing data, which would reduce the defensibility and consistency of Government estimates and increase risk in budget formulation and contract evaluation. Additionally, alternative solutions would jeopardize NASA's ability to plan, fund, and execute mission-critical programs. Inaccurate or

inconsistent cost data will drive cost growth, force unplanned funding reallocations, and introduce delays into project lifecycles, undermining schedule commitments for exploration, science, and technology initiatives. Such disruptions diminish the Agency's capability to deliver safe, reliable, and timely mission outcomes in support of national space objectives.

Based on this market research, RSMMeans continues to represent the most appropriate solution to meet the Government's requirement, and renewal through a sole source acquisition with Gordian is recommended.

9. FAR 6.104-1(a)(9) – Any other facts supporting the use of other than full and open competition:

None.

10. FAR 6.104-1(a)(10) – A listing of the sources, if any, that expressed an interest in writing in the acquisition:

A notice of NASA's intent to award this sole-source action was synopsized on the GPE website (Sam.gov) per FAR part 5 (See Section 6 above).

11. FAR 6.104-1(a)(11) – A statement of actions, if any, the agency may take to remove or overcome any barriers to competition before any subsequent acquisition for the supplies or services required:

The Agency will continue to examine the market in the future for alternative solutions or new sources before executing any subsequent acquisitions for the same requirements.